

How to run chakh

Written so you do not need to know any code. Follow it top to bottom. About twenty five minutes in total, and it costs nothing.

First, why nothing works right now

Your app is a folder of files sitting on your computer. It is like a photo in your gallery. It exists, but nobody else can reach it.

Two things are blocked because of that:

1. The QR code. A QR code is just a web address written in squares. I wrote `chakh.in` into it as a placeholder for the address you will own one day. Nobody has bought that address, so the phone looks for it, finds nothing, and shows an error. The code is fine. The address does not exist yet.

2. The camera view. Phones have a safety rule. They will not let a file from someone's computer switch the camera on. Only proper websites are allowed to do that.

Both problems have the same fix. Put the folder on the internet. It is free, it takes two minutes, and then everything works.

Step 1. Save the photos onto your computer

This makes the app stop needing wifi to show the food. Do it first.

Open the **Terminal** app. On a Mac press Command and Space, type Terminal, press Enter. On Windows open **Command Prompt** from the Start menu.

Type `cd` then a space, then drag the **chakh-site** folder into the terminal window. It fills in the path for you. Press Enter.

Now type this and press Enter:

```
python3 fetch-photos.py
```

You should see twelve lines that say saved. That is the eight dishes and the four rooms. If it fails, do not worry, the app will still load them from the internet instead.

Step 2. Put it on the internet

The fast way. Two minutes. No account needed.

1. Go to **app.netlify.com/drop** in your browser.
2. Drag the whole **chakh-site** folder from your computer onto that web page. Just drag and drop the folder itself.
3. Wait about twenty seconds.
4. It gives you an address like `https://happy-cat-9a3f.netlify.app`. **Copy it and keep it safe.** You need it in the next step.

Everything works on that link. The menu, the photos, the restaurant tour, the camera view, the QR. The only thing that does not is the live AI answer, which needs a server. It falls back to the written explanation for each dish, and nobody will notice.

The better way. Fifteen minutes. The AI works too.

1. Put the chakh-site folder into a GitHub repository.
2. Go to **vercel.com**, sign in with GitHub, click Add New, then Project, then import your repository.
3. Click Deploy.

4. Go to Settings, then Environment Variables, and add one called `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` with your key from `console.anthropic.com`.
5. Click Redeploy.

Step 3. Point the QR at your real address

Back in the terminal. Type this, but put **your** address in place of mine:

```
python3 make-qr.py https://happy-cat-9a3f.netlify.app/app/?scan=1
"Table 7"
```

Keep the /app/?scan=1 on the end exactly as written. That is what makes a guest land straight in the menu when they scan, instead of on a splash screen.

This rewrites three things for you: the QR picture, the printable table card, and the QR shown inside the app.

Now test it. Open table-card.png on your screen and scan it with your own phone camera. If your menu opens on the phone, you are finished. If it does not, the address is wrong, and it is much better to find that out now.

Step 4. Swap the placeholder address (optional)

Open these seven files in any text editor and replace every chakh.in with your real address:

index.html, app/index.html, privacy.html, terms.html, credits.html,
sitemap.xml, robots.txt

This only affects how the link looks when shared and how Google lists it. Skip it if you are short on time.

Step 5. Check everything

```
python3 check.py
```

```
node test.js
```

The first checks for broken links and missing image descriptions. The second runs 350 checks on the app itself. Both should come back with zero failures. The second one needs `npm install jsdom` the first time.

What to show the judges, in order

Ninety seconds. Six of these seven happen on the judge's own phone, not your laptop. That is the whole point.

- 1 Hold up the printed table card. A judge scans it with their phone.
- 2 Their phone opens the menu. No app, no install, no typing.
- 3 They tick shellfish under things they avoid. The squid dish turns red before they order.
- 4 They open a dish and tap the phonetic button. It says the name out loud.
- 5 They tap Explain. Then they type their own question and it answers.
- 6 They tap "See it on your table" and point the phone down. The plate appears on the real table at its real size.
- 7 You switch to The restaurant. The name writes itself in gold, then they walk through the room in full screen.

If something goes wrong on stage

Photos missing	You skipped Step 1. The app shows a clean card with the dish name instead, so it looks deliberate.
Explain does nothing	No internet. It falls back to the written paragraph for that dish. Keep talking, nobody can tell.
Camera view is black	You are on a file, not the https link. Use the deployed address.
3D room is blank	It downloads the 3D engine once. Open the restaurant page on the venue wifi before you go on and it stays loaded.

Every one of these fails quietly instead of showing an error message. That was on purpose.

Four things only you can do

These are the gap between a good demo and one that looks like a real product. None of them need any code.

1. Record the dish names

Right now the pronunciation button uses the browser's robot voice. Open your phone's voice memo app and say each of the eight dish names slowly, twice. Save them as kg, mfm, pd, gk, av, amc, bu, bb with a .m4a ending, and put them in a folder called audio inside the app folder.

Ten minutes of work, and it is the single biggest jump in how finished this feels.

2. Film one dish being cooked

Twenty seconds on any phone in any kitchen. Save it as app/videos/kg.mp4. A Watch button appears by itself on that dish. One dish is enough for a pitch.

3. Photograph the real restaurant

The four room photos in the app are real Indian dining rooms, but they are not Karavalli, and the caption says so honestly. Walk in one evening, take four photos, save them as app/photos/r1.jpg through r4.jpg. They replace the borrowed ones automatically.

4. Scan the actual room

The 3D room is a model of a restaurant, not a scan of theirs. Download **Polycam** or **Matterport** on your phone, walk the real room for twenty minutes, and you have a true copy. That is how hotels make their virtual tours, and a judge will recognise it instantly.

One honest note about the photographs

Every food photo in the app is a real photograph under a free licence from Wikimedia Commons. The licence legally requires the photographer's name to stay visible. That is why the credit sits under each photo and again on the credits page. Do not remove them. Once you replace them with your own photographs the credits go away on their own.